CSE 485: Capstone Project - Course Syllabus

Lakeshore Institute of Technology, Department of Computer Science. Fall 2026.

Course information

The course runs from September 1 to December 11, 2026. Class meets on Tuesdays and Thursdays from 2:00 PM to 3:15 PM in Room 214 of Harbor Hall.

Instructor: Dr. Priya Raman, priya.raman@lit.example. Office hours are on Wednesdays from 10:00 AM to 12:00 PM in Room 318 of Harbor Hall.

Teaching assistant: Marcus Bell. His office hours are on Fridays from 1:00 PM to 3:00 PM, online.

Description

In this course, teams of three or four students design, build and demonstrate a software product for a real or realistic user. The course emphasises requirements, design reviews and working in a team.

Learning outcomes

- Write testable requirements and trace them to design decisions.
- Plan and track work in a small team using an agile board.
- Present a working prototype and defend design choices.

Grading

The final grade is made up of the following parts.

- Project proposal: 10 percent
- Requirements specification: 15 percent
- Design review: 15 percent
- Prototype demo: 20 percent
- Final report: 25 percent
- Peer evaluation: 5 percent
- Participation: 10 percent

Late work

Late work loses 10 percent per day, up to five days. After five days the work is not accepted.

Extension requests must be sent to the instructor at least 48 hours before the deadline. An extension is granted at the instructor's discretion and does not carry a penalty.

Academic integrity

All submitted work must be the team's own. Using code or text from another source without citing it is a violation of the academic integrity policy.

Schedule of deadlines

- Project proposal: due Friday, September 18, 2026 at 11:59 PM
- Requirements specification: due Friday, October 9, 2026 at 11:59 PM
- Design review: Friday, October 30, 2026
- Prototype demo: Friday, November 20, 2026
- Final report: due Friday, December 4, 2026 at 11:59 PM

There is no final exam in this course.

Required textbook

Software Engineering in Practice, 4th edition, by R. Whitfield. The bookstore lists it at 89.95 dollars.

Course tools

Teams use the course portal to submit work and an agile board of their choice to track tasks. Source code must be kept in a version-control repository that the instructor can access.